

Pitt, the French Revolution, Napoleon and the Union with Ireland (1783–1815)

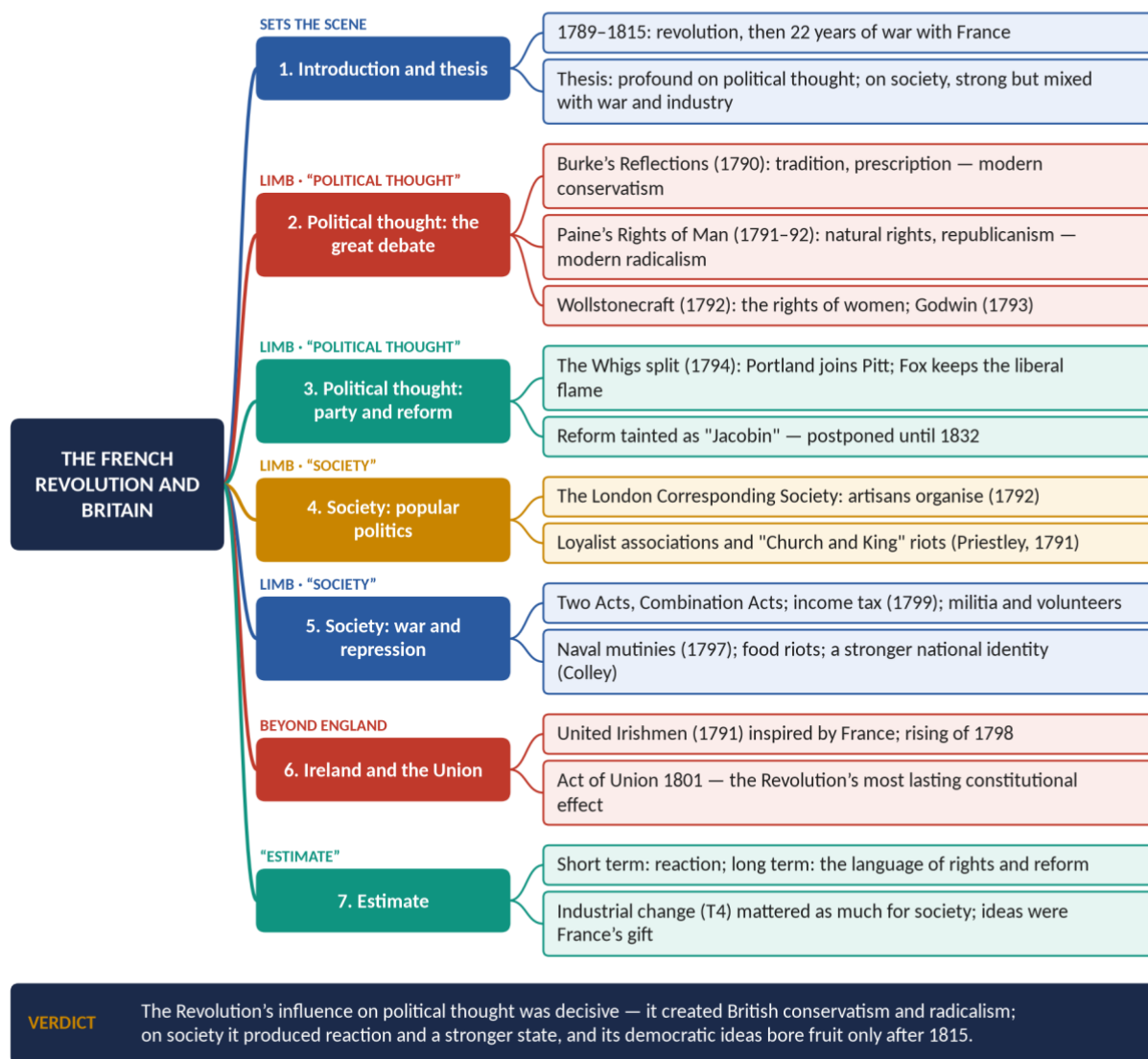
Every past question on the French Revolution's influence on Britain and the Union of 1801 — answered in full, with answer maps

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2020 · Q3 · SECTION A (= CSS 2022 · Q5)

Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.

KEY WORDS "Estimate" · "influence" · "English society" · "political thought"

IT DEMANDS Two areas — society and political thought — and a judgement of HOW GREAT the influence was ("estimate"). Short-term and long-term.



Four full answers, the identical 2022 repeat shown with its adaptation, and one short note (2016–2025); the three past MCQs solved; five predicted questions with outlines.

Topic 3 of 10 · companion to T3KB (the Knowledge Base)

Contents

HOW TO USE THIS · Updating the contents

Right-click the contents → **Update Field** → **Update entire table**, before saving as PDF.

How to Use These Answers.....	5
Answer 1 · Measures to Check the Influence of the French Revolution	6
The model answer.....	7
(1) Introduction and thesis	7
(2) The influence that alarmed the government.....	7
(3) Measure one: propaganda and loyalism.....	7
(4) Measure two: prosecutions	7
(5) Measure three: emergency laws.....	7
(6) Measure four: force and war	8
(7) Measure five: Ireland	8
(8) Did the measures work?.....	8
(9) Conclusion	9
Answer 2 · The Influence of the French Revolution on English Society and Political Thought	10
The model answer.....	11
(1) Introduction and thesis	11
Political thought.....	11
(2) Burke and conservatism	11
(3) Paine and radicalism	11
(4) The wider debate	11
(5) The effect on parties and reform	12
English society.....	12
(6) Popular politics and loyalism.....	12
(7) Repression and the state.....	12
(8) War, economy and identity.....	12
(9) Ireland	13
(10) Estimate.....	13
(11) Conclusion	13
Answer 3 · The Same Question, Set Again	14
How to use Answer 2 in 2022 (or 2027)	14
Answer 4 · "A Sort of Panic": The After-Effects of the French Revolution.....	15
The model answer.....	16
(1) Introduction and thesis	16
(2) From welcome to fear	16
(3) Was there a panic?.....	16
The after-effects.....	16
(4) Political	16
(5) Legal	17
(6) Social and intellectual	17
(7) Ireland	17

(8) War	17
(9) Conclusion	17
Short Note	19
Impact of the French Revolution on the British Economy and Society	19
(1) Introduction.....	19
(2) The economy	19
(3) Society	19
(4) Assessment.....	20
Answer 5 · The Act of Union 1801: Controversies, Nationalism and Stability	21
The model answer	22
(1) Introduction and thesis	22
(2) Background.....	22
(3) The British perspective.....	23
(4) The Irish perspectives.....	23
(5) The controversies	24
(6) The impact on Irish nationalism	24
(7) The impact on the stability of the United Kingdom	24
(8) Conclusion	24
Part Two — The Past MCQs, Solved	25
CSS 2024 · MCQ 15	25
CSS 2026 · MCQ 5	25
CSS 2026 · MCQ 15	25
Part Three — Five Predicted Questions, with Outlines	26
Predicted 1 · "How did Britain contribute to the defeat of Napoleon?"	26
Predicted 2 · "Assess the impact of the Napoleonic Wars on Britain."	26
Predicted 3 · "Evaluate Pitt the Younger as a peacetime reformer and a war minister."	26
Predicted 4 · "Compare the political ideas of Edmund Burke and Thomas Paine."	26
Predicted 5 · "What were the causes and consequences of the Irish rebellion of 1798?"	27

How to Use These Answers

#	Paper	Question (short)	Answer
1	2016 Q2	Measures adopted to check the influence of the French Revolution	Answer 1
2	2020 Q3	Influence of the Revolution on English society and political thought	Answer 2
3	2022 Q5	Identical to 2020 Q3 — how to reuse Answer 2	Answer 3
4	2023 Q3	"A sort of panic" — the after-effects of the Revolution	Answer 4
5	2025 Q8(a)	Short note: impact on the British economy and society	Short note
6	2025 Q3	The Act of Union 1801: controversies, nationalism, stability	Answer 5

Every answer has: the question as set · its **answer map** · **decoding the question** · a **model answer** with numbered headings, a figure and a verdict · **why this answer scores**.

TRAP — DO NOT FALL INTO IT · The same material, four angles

The four Revolution questions draw on **one body of knowledge** (T3KB, Chapter 2) but ask for **measures** (2016), **influence** (2020, 2022), **panic and after-effects** (2023) and **economic and social impact** (2025). Build your headings from the question's own words each time.

Answer 1 · Measures to Check the Influence of the French Revolution

THE QUESTION · CSS 2016 · Q2 · Section A · 20 marks

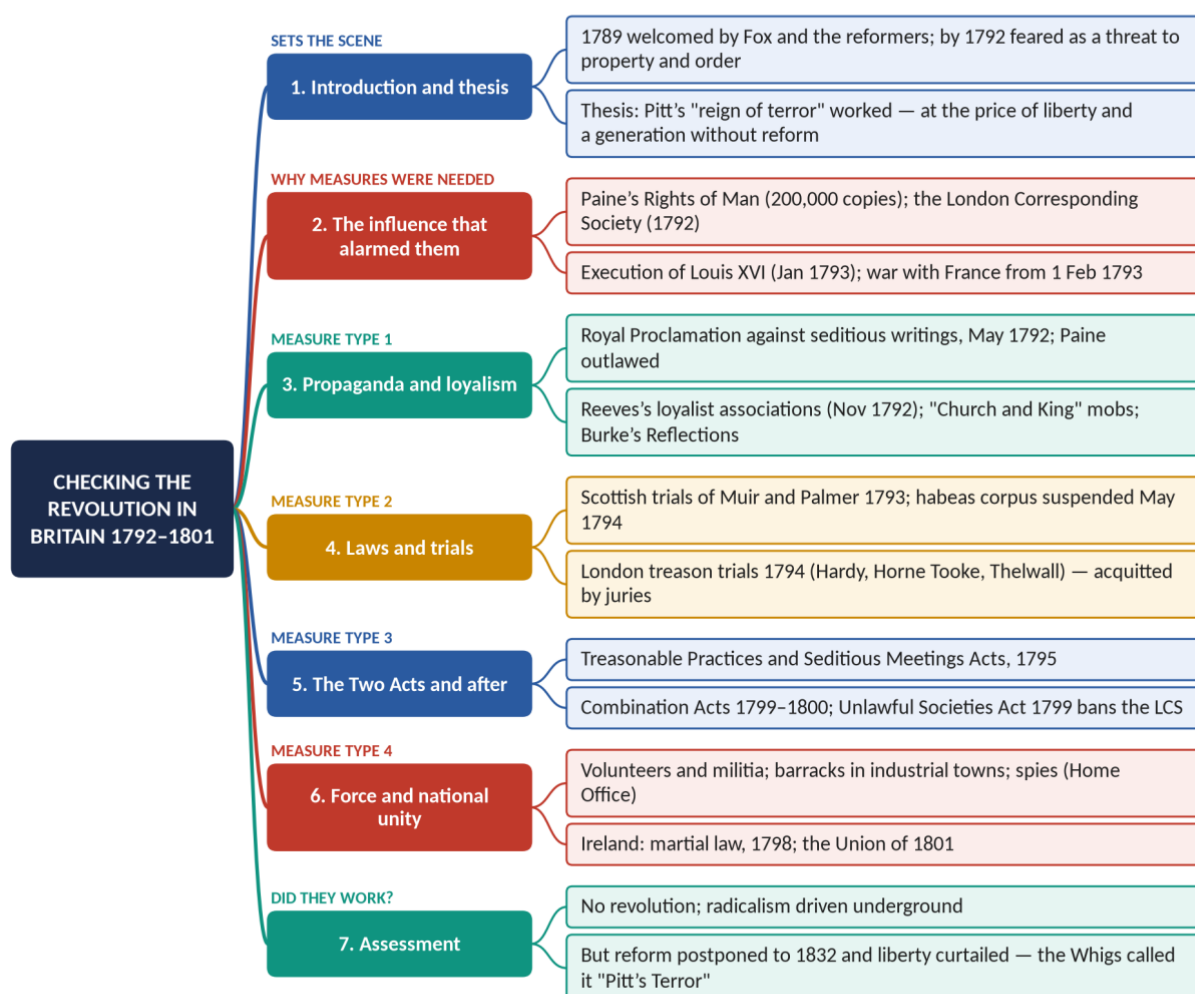
What measures were adopted by England to check the influence of the French Revolution of 1789 on England?

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2016 · Q2 · SECTION I

What measures were adopted by England to check the influence of the French Revolution of 1789 on England?

KEY WORDS "What measures" · "to check the influence" · "French Revolution of 1789"

IT DEMANDS Describe and explain the government's counter-measures — legal, political, propaganda, military — and judge whether they worked and at what cost.



VERDICT

The measures succeeded in preventing revolution, largely because most Britons were loyal anyway; they succeeded less in destroying the radical idea, which revived after 1815.

Figure 1 · The answer map for CSS 2016 · Q2 · Section A: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"**What measures**" — the answer is built on the government's actions, grouped by type (propaganda, trials, laws, force, Ireland). "**To check the influence**" means you must first say briefly what influence was feared, and end by judging whether the measures worked.

The model answer

(1) Introduction and thesis

The French Revolution of **1789** was first welcomed in Britain, but by **1792** its spread of radical ideas — and from **1 February 1793** a war with France — convinced **Pitt's** government that Britain faced revolution at home. It answered with propaganda, prosecutions, emergency laws and force, a programme the Whigs called "**Pitt's Terror**". The measures succeeded in preventing revolution, but at the price of liberty and a generation's delay to reform.

(2) The influence that alarmed the government

- **Ideas:** **Paine's** *Rights of Man* (1791–92), which sold about 200,000 copies, attacked monarchy and aristocracy and demanded a republic.
- **Organisation:** the **London Corresponding Society** (January 1792), founded by the shoemaker **Thomas Hardy**, united artisans across the country behind **manhood suffrage** and annual parliaments.
- **Events in France:** the September Massacres (1792), the execution of **Louis XVI** (21 January 1793) and war.
- **Ireland:** the **United Irishmen** (1791) looked to France for a republic.

(3) Measure one: propaganda and loyalism

- The **Royal Proclamation** against seditious writings (**May 1792**); Paine was tried in his absence and **outlawed**.
- **John Reeves's Association for Preserving Liberty and Property** (November 1792) spread to hundreds of towns, reporting radicals and distributing loyalist tracts.
- **Burke's Reflections** (1790) supplied the intellectual case; "**Church and King**" crowds supplied the muscle — Priestley's house in Birmingham was burned in 1791.

(4) Measure two: prosecutions

- **Scotland, 1793:** **Thomas Muir** and **Thomas Palmer** were sentenced to transportation for sedition.
- **London, 1794:** **Hardy, Horne Tooke** and **Thelwall** were tried for **high treason** — and **acquitted** by juries, a sharp limit on the government's power.

(5) Measure three: emergency laws

Year	Law	What it did
1793	Aliens Act	Registration and expulsion of foreigners

Year	Law	What it did
1794	Habeas corpus suspended	Detention without trial (to 1801, with a gap)
1795	Two Acts	Treasonable Practices (words could be treason); Seditious Meetings (no meeting of 50+ without a magistrate)
1797	Newspaper Act	Registration of printers and presses
1799	Unlawful Societies Act	Banned the LCS and the United Irishmen
1799–1800	Combination Acts	Banned trade unions

(6) Measure four: force and war

- The **militia** and **volunteer corps** — over 400,000 men by 1804 — and new **barracks** in industrial towns.
- A network of Home Office **spies** and informers.
- Mutineers at the **Nore** (1797) executed.

(7) Measure five: Ireland

Martial law and brutal disarming (1797–98) crushed the **1798** rising; the **Act of Union** (in force 1 January 1801) abolished the Irish Parliament to close the "back door" to France.

THE FRENCH REVOLUTION IN BRITAIN: FROM ENTHUSIASM TO REPRESSION

Why reform was delayed forty years — and why it came in 1832

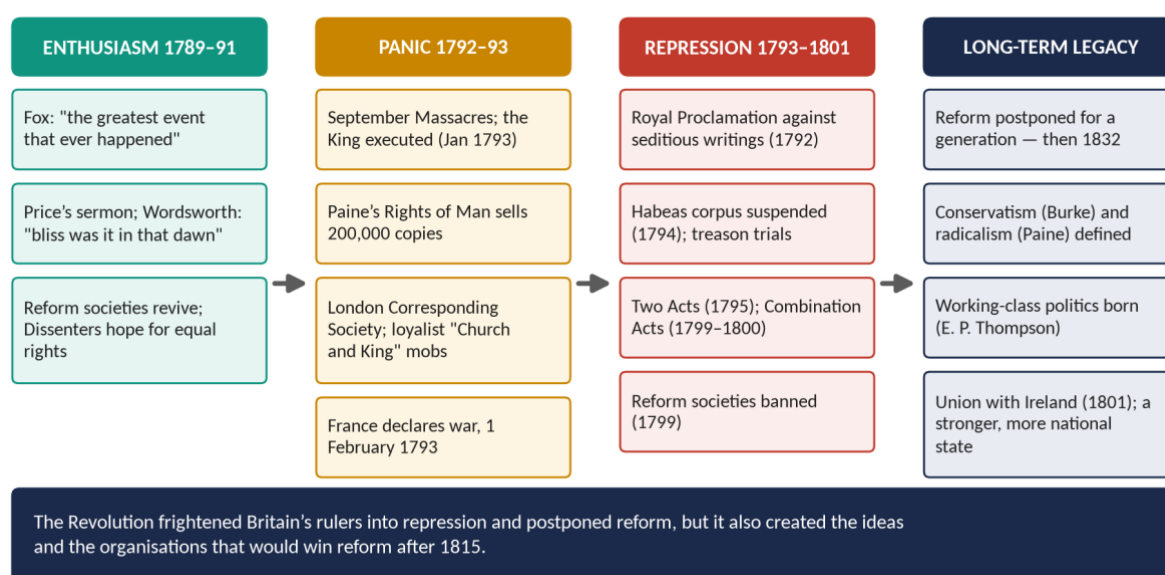


Figure 2 · From enthusiasm to repression: the British response to the Revolution.

(8) Did the measures work?

Yes	But
No revolution in Britain; radical societies broken by 1799	Most Britons were loyal anyway (Dickinson) — the threat was exaggerated

Yes	But
Loyalism mobilised on a mass scale	Juries acquitted the treason defendants in 1794
Ireland secured for the war	Radicalism went underground and revived after 1815 (Peterloo, Chartism)
National unity for twenty-two years of war	Reform was postponed until 1832 ; trade unions illegal until 1824

(9) Conclusion

To check the influence of the French Revolution, Britain used **propaganda, prosecutions, emergency laws, force and the Union with Ireland**. They worked in the sense that mattered to Pitt — there was no British revolution — but they worked largely because most of the nation was loyal, and they did not kill the radical idea. They drove it underground, where it waited for the end of the war.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES

The measures are grouped by type rather than listed, the influence being checked is defined first, and the final table answers the implied question — did they work? — with evidence on both sides.

Answer 2 · The Influence of the French Revolution on English Society and Political Thought

THE QUESTION · CSS 2020 · Q3 · Section A · 20 marks

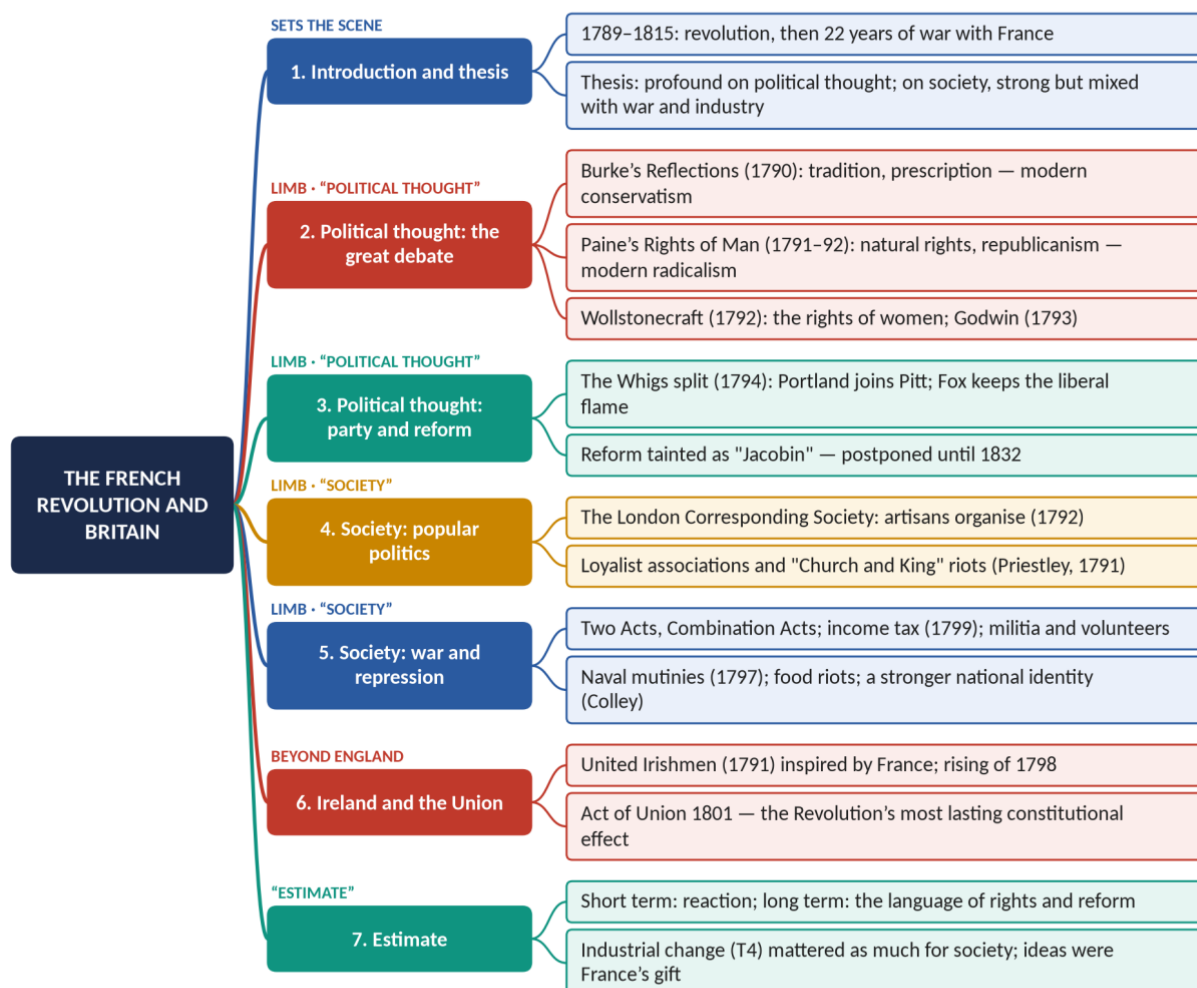
Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2020 · Q3 · SECTION A (= CSS 2022 · Q5)

Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.

KEY WORDS "Estimate" · "influence" · "English society" · "political thought"

IT DEMANDS Two areas — society and political thought — and a judgement of HOW GREAT the influence was ("estimate"). Short-term and long-term.



VERDICT

The Revolution's influence on political thought was decisive — it created British conservatism and radicalism; on society it produced reaction and a stronger state, and its democratic ideas bore fruit only after 1815.

Figure 3 · The answer map for CSS 2020 · Q3 · Section A: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

"**Estimate**" means measure the **size** of the influence, not just describe it. Two named areas: **English society** and **political thought**. Separate them, and distinguish short-term from long-term effects. This exact question was set again in **2022**.

The model answer

(1) Introduction and thesis

The French Revolution of **1789**, followed by twenty-two years of war with France (1793–1815), was the most important foreign influence on British life in the period. Its influence on **political thought** was decisive: the argument between **Burke** and **Paine** created modern British **conservatism** and **radicalism**. Its influence on **society** was strong but mixed — it produced a mass loyalism, a first working-class politics, repression and a stronger state — and it was matched by the other great force of the age, the Industrial Revolution.

Political thought

(2) Burke and conservatism

Edmund Burke's *Reflections on the Revolution in France* (**1790**) argued that society is "a partnership... between those who are living, those who are dead, and those who are to be born"; that rights come from inherited institutions, not abstract reason; and that revolution would end in terror and dictatorship — which it did. He also distinguished 1688, a conservative restoration, from 1789, a revolution. Burke gave the **Tory** party a philosophy it has used ever since.

(3) Paine and radicalism

Thomas Paine's *Rights of Man* (**1791–92**) replied that each generation may govern itself, that hereditary monarchy and aristocracy were absurd, and that a republic was best. Part 2 proposed **old-age pensions, family allowances and public education** paid for by progressive taxation. Selling perhaps **200,000** copies, it became the bible of British radicalism.

(4) The wider debate

- **Mary Wollstonecraft**, *A Vindication of the Rights of Woman* (**1792**): the first great British case for women's equality.
- **William Godwin**, *Political Justice* (**1793**): reason and the abolition of coercive government.
- **Price** and the **Dissenters**: the Revolution as the fulfilment of 1688.

THE GREAT ARGUMENT: BURKE AGAINST PAINE

The debate that created modern British conservatism and radicalism

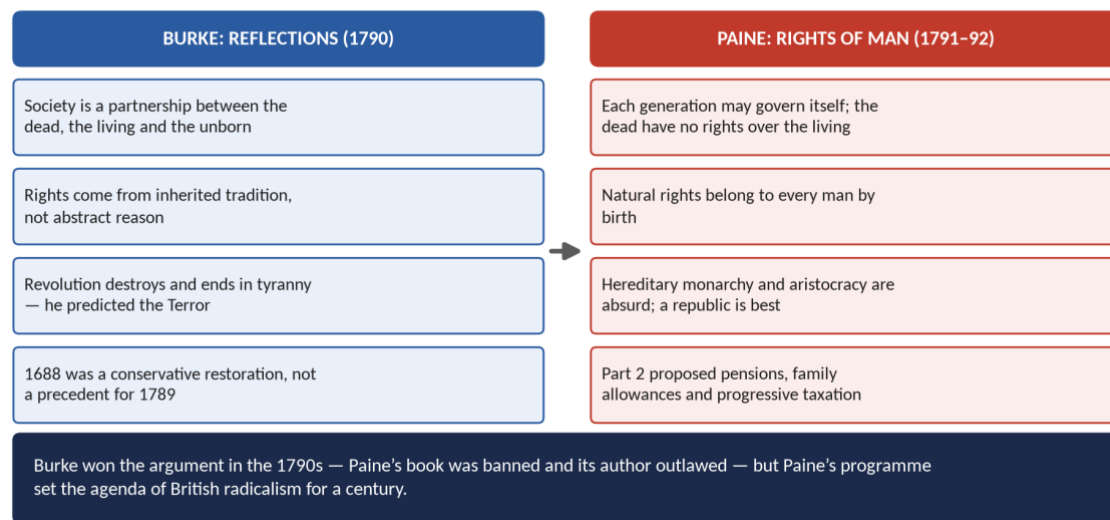


Figure 4 · Burke against Paine: the debate that defined British political thought.

(5) The effect on parties and reform

- The **Whig party split** in **1794**: Portland's conservative Whigs joined **Pitt**, while **Fox** kept a small liberal opposition.
- Reform became identified with "**Jacobinism**": the moderate reform movement of the 1780s collapsed and parliamentary reform was postponed until **1832**.

English society

(6) Popular politics and loyalism

- **Radicalism**: the **London Corresponding Society** (1792) and similar societies brought artisans into national politics. For **E. P. Thompson**, this was when the English working class began to "make itself".
- **Loyalism**: a larger mass movement — Reeves's associations, "Church and King" crowds, over **400,000** volunteers by 1804 (**H. T. Dickinson**).

(7) Repression and the state

Habeas corpus suspended (**1794**); the **Two Acts** (1795); the **Combination Acts** (1799–1800) banning trade unions until 1824. The state grew stronger: **income tax** (1799), a larger army and navy, a Home Office intelligence network.

(8) War, economy and identity

High taxes and food prices, food riots (1795, 1800), the naval **mutinies** (1797) and the Bank's **suspension of cash payments** (1797). The long war with a revolutionary, Catholic, republican enemy forged a stronger **British** identity (**Linda Colley**). Evangelical religion grew as the ruling class looked to morality as a defence against revolution.

(9) Ireland

The Revolution inspired the **United Irishmen**, the **1798** rising and the **Act of Union** (1801) — its most lasting constitutional effect on the British Isles.

(10) Estimate

Area	Short-term influence (1790s)	Long-term influence (after 1815)
Political thought	Very great: conservatism and radicalism defined	Very great: the language of rights, reform and democracy
Parties and reform	Great: Whig split, reform postponed	Great: Tory identity; the reform movement of 1815–32
Society	Great: loyalism, repression, war	Moderate: industrial change (T4) mattered as much

(11) Conclusion

The French Revolution's influence on English **political thought** was profound and permanent: Burke and Paine between them wrote the terms of British political argument for the next century. Its influence on **society** was great in the short term — mobilisation, repression, war — but in the long term it worked alongside, and was sometimes overshadowed by, the Industrial Revolution. Its democratic promise was delayed, not destroyed: it bore fruit in the reform movements after 1815.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES

"Estimate" is answered with an explicit scale (very great, great, moderate) in a table, and both named areas get their own sections. Named thinkers, laws and dates support every claim, and the answer places the Revolution beside the Industrial Revolution — the comparison that shows judgement.

Answer 3 · The Same Question, Set Again

THE QUESTION · CSS 2022 · Q5 · Section A · 20 marks

Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought.

DECODING THE QUESTION

2022 Q5 is **word for word** the same as **2020 Q3**: "Estimate the influence of the French Revolution on English society and political thought." Answer 2 is the answer. The only question is how to present it freshly.

How to use Answer 2 in 2022 (or 2027)

1. **Use the same structure** — political thought, then society, then the estimate table. It is built on the question's own words.
2. **Strengthen "estimate"**: open your conclusion with a single sentence of measurement — *"The influence was greatest on political thought, considerable on politics and reform, and significant but shared with industrialisation on society."*
3. **Add one extra piece of evidence per section** if you have time: the **Priestley riots** (1791); the **1794 treason acquittals**; the **Seditious Meetings Act** limit of 50; the **Nore mutiny**.
4. **Add Ireland** as a separate short heading if the 2020 version did not have it — the Union of 1801 is the Revolution's most concrete constitutional legacy.

WHAT THE EXAMINER HAS ASKED · Why this matters

An identical question twice in three years is the clearest evidence in the whole record that this family is a favourite. Master Answer 2; it is one of the most likely questions in any future paper.

Answer 4 · "A Sort of Panic": The After-Effects of the French Revolution

THE QUESTION · CSS 2023 · Q3 · Section A · 20 marks

'The English people got so much frightened by the developments in France that there prevailed a sort of panic across the country.' Analyse the after-effects of the French Revolution on England.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2023 · Q3 · SECTION A

"The English people got so much frightened by the developments in France that there prevailed a sort of panic across the country." Analyse the after-effects of the French Revolution on England.

KEY WORDS "so much frightened" · "panic" · "Analyse" · "after-effects"

IT DEMANDS Test the claim of panic (who panicked, and why), then analyse the after-effects — political, legal, social, intellectual, Irish — and say how deep and lasting they were.

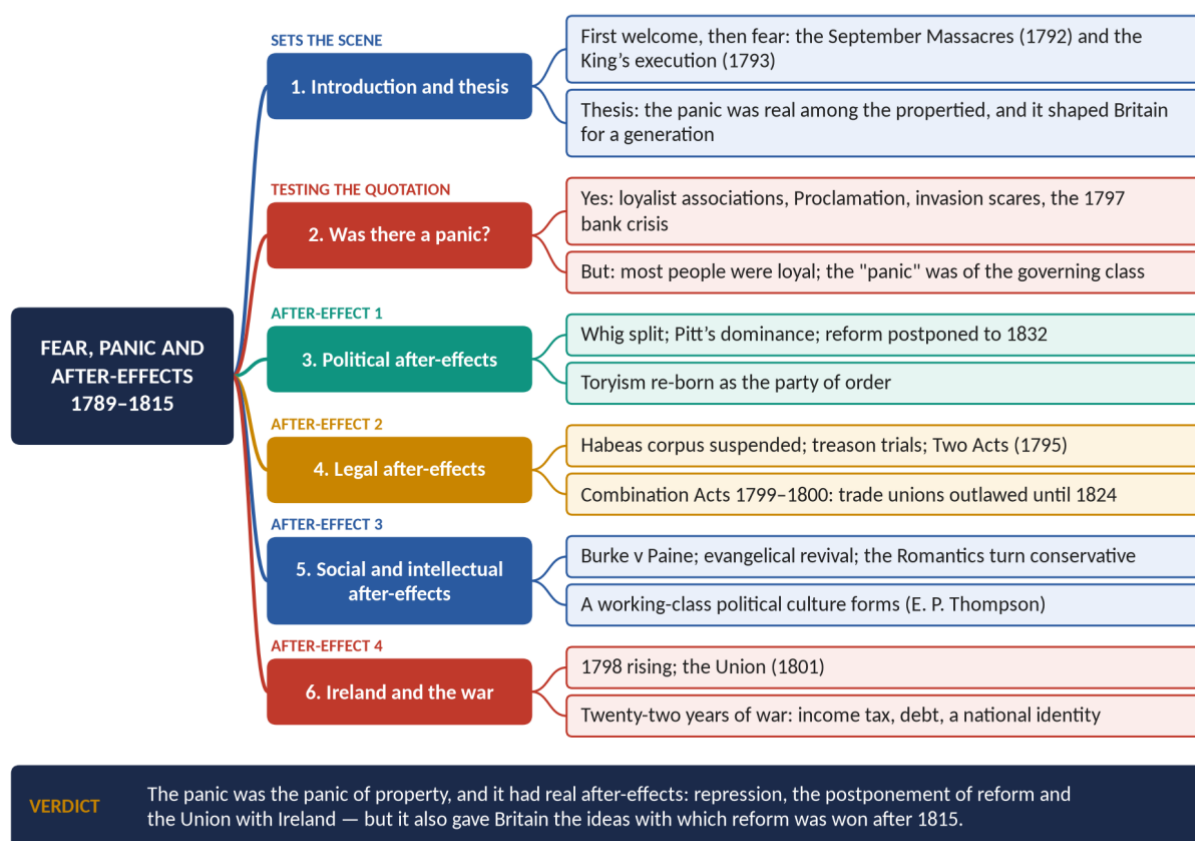


Figure 5 · The answer map for CSS 2023 · Q3 · Section A: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Two tasks. First, **test the quotation**: was there a "panic"? Who panicked, and why? Second, **analyse the after-effects** on England — political, legal, social, intellectual, Irish — and judge how deep and lasting they were.

The model answer

(1) Introduction and thesis

The quotation is right that fear gripped England — but it was, above all, the fear of the **propertied classes**. From **1792** the violence in France, the spread of Paine's ideas and war with France produced a genuine panic among Britain's rulers, and that panic shaped the country for a generation: repression, a Tory ascendancy, the postponement of reform, and the Union with Ireland.

(2) From welcome to fear

In **1789** Fox, Price and Wordsworth welcomed the Revolution. By **1792** the mood had turned: the **September Massacres**, the abolition of the monarchy, the French offer of help to all peoples seeking liberty (the **Edict of Fraternity**, November 1792) and the opening of the Scheldt. The execution of **Louis XVI** (21 January 1793) and the declaration of war (**1 February 1793**) completed the transformation.

(3) Was there a panic?

Evidence of panic	Evidence against
Royal Proclamation (1792); Paine outlawed	Most people were loyal : loyalist associations far outnumbered radical societies
Loyalist associations in hundreds of towns	Juries acquitted the treason defendants (1794)
Habeas corpus suspended; treason trials	The LCS had perhaps 5,000 members at most
Invasion scares (1797–98, 1803–05); bank crisis (1797)	No serious revolutionary plot in England was ever proved

The panic, then, was real among the **governing class** and was fed by events; the country as a whole was more loyal than frightened.

The after-effects

(4) Political

- The **Whig split** (1794) left **Pitt** and his successors dominant; the Tories held power almost continuously until **1830**.
- **Reform** became "Jacobinism" and was postponed until **1832**.

(5) Legal

The **Two Acts** (1795), the **Combination Acts** (1799–1800) and the **Unlawful Societies Act** (1799) curtailed speech, assembly and trade unions; the machinery was revived after 1815 in the **Six Acts** (1819).

(6) Social and intellectual

- **Burke v Paine**: conservatism and radicalism defined.
- A first working-class political culture (**E. P. Thompson**), driven underground.
- **Evangelical** religion and moral reform as a defence against revolution; the Romantic poets turned conservative.

(7) Ireland

The Revolution inspired the **United Irishmen** and the **1798** rising (about 30,000 dead); Pitt's answer was the **Act of Union** (1801).

(8) War

Twenty-two years of war: **income tax** (1799), a debt of about **£745 million**, and a stronger British identity (**Colley**).

REVOLUTION, REACTION AND A WORLD WAR, 1783–1815

blue = government at home · red = radicals · gold = war · teal = Ireland

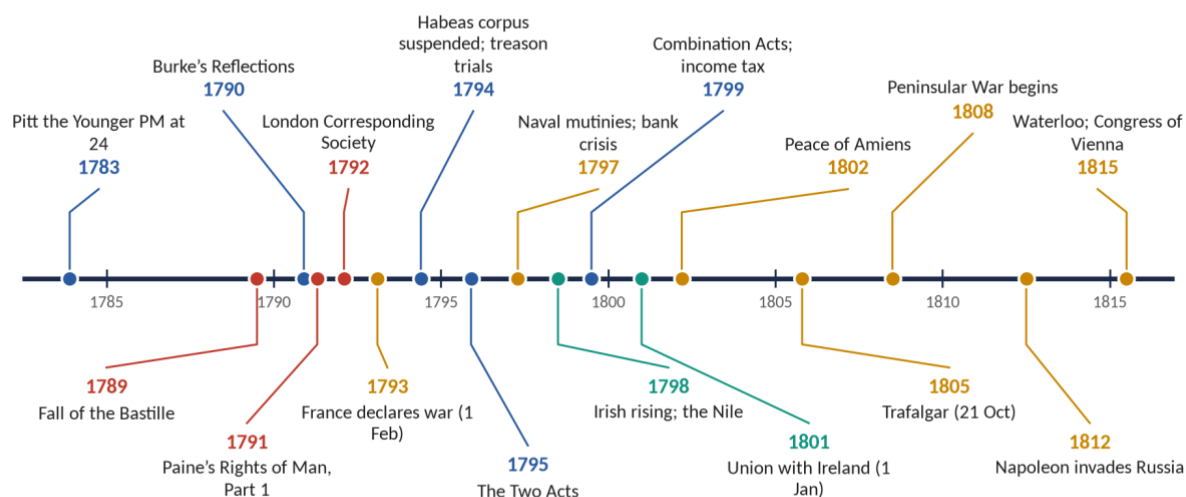


Figure 6 · From the Bastille to Waterloo: the sequence of fear, repression and war.

(9) Conclusion

The quotation captures the mood of Britain's rulers in the 1790s: they were frightened, and they acted on their fear. The after-effects were **repression, Tory dominance, the postponement of reform, the Union with Ireland and a long, costly war** — but also

the birth of modern conservatism and radicalism. The panic delayed reform by a generation; it did not prevent it.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES

The quotation is tested with evidence on both sides before the after-effects are analysed, and the after-effects are grouped by type. Distinguishing the panic of the propertied from the loyalty of the majority is the judgement the question rewards.

Short Note

Impact of the French Revolution on the British Economy and Society

THE QUESTION · CSS 2025 · Q8(a) · Section B · short note (10 marks)

Write a short note on: Impact of the French Revolution on the British economy and society

DECODING THE QUESTION

A 10-mark short note (450–600 words). Keep it to **economy** and **society**; political thought appears only as it affected society.

(1) Introduction

The French Revolution (**1789**) and the wars it produced (**1793–1815**) reshaped the British economy and society as much through **war** as through **ideas**.

(2) The economy

- **Taxation: income tax** introduced by Pitt in **1799** (2s in the pound on incomes over £200); indirect taxes on almost everything.
- **Debt**: the National Debt rose from about **£240 million** to about **£745 million**.
- **Money**: the Bank of England **suspended cash payments** (1797–1821).
- **Trade**: the **Continental System** (1806) and the **Orders in Council** (1807) disrupted exports; new markets were found in South America and the empire.
- **Industry and agriculture**: war demand stimulated **iron** and **cotton**; high wheat prices encouraged **enclosure**; the **Corn Law** of **1815** protected farmers after the war.

(3) Society

- **Politics of the people**: the **London Corresponding Society** (1792) and the first working-class political organisations (**E. P. Thompson**).
- **Loyalism**: Reeves's associations; "Church and King" crowds; **400,000** volunteers by 1804.
- **Repression**: habeas corpus suspended (1794); the **Two Acts** (1795); the **Combination Acts** (1799–1800) outlawing trade unions.
- **Hardship**: food riots (1795, 1800); the naval **mutinies** (1797); after 1815, unemployment among some 300,000 demobilised men, **Luddism** and **Peterloo** (1819).
- **Identity and religion**: a stronger **British** patriotism (**Colley**); evangelical revival.

(4) Assessment

The Revolution's economic impact came mainly through **war finance** — income tax and debt — and its social impact through **mobilisation and repression**. Together they left post-war Britain heavily taxed, socially divided and politically restless: the setting for the Age of Reform.

Answer 5 · The Act of Union 1801: Controversies, Nationalism and Stability

THE QUESTION · CSS 2025 · Q3 · Section A · 20 marks

Analyze the controversies surrounding the Act of Union 1801, focusing on the differing perspectives of Irish and British politicians. Assess its impact on Irish nationalism and the stability of the United Kingdom.

ANSWER MAP · CSS 2025 · Q3 · SECTION A

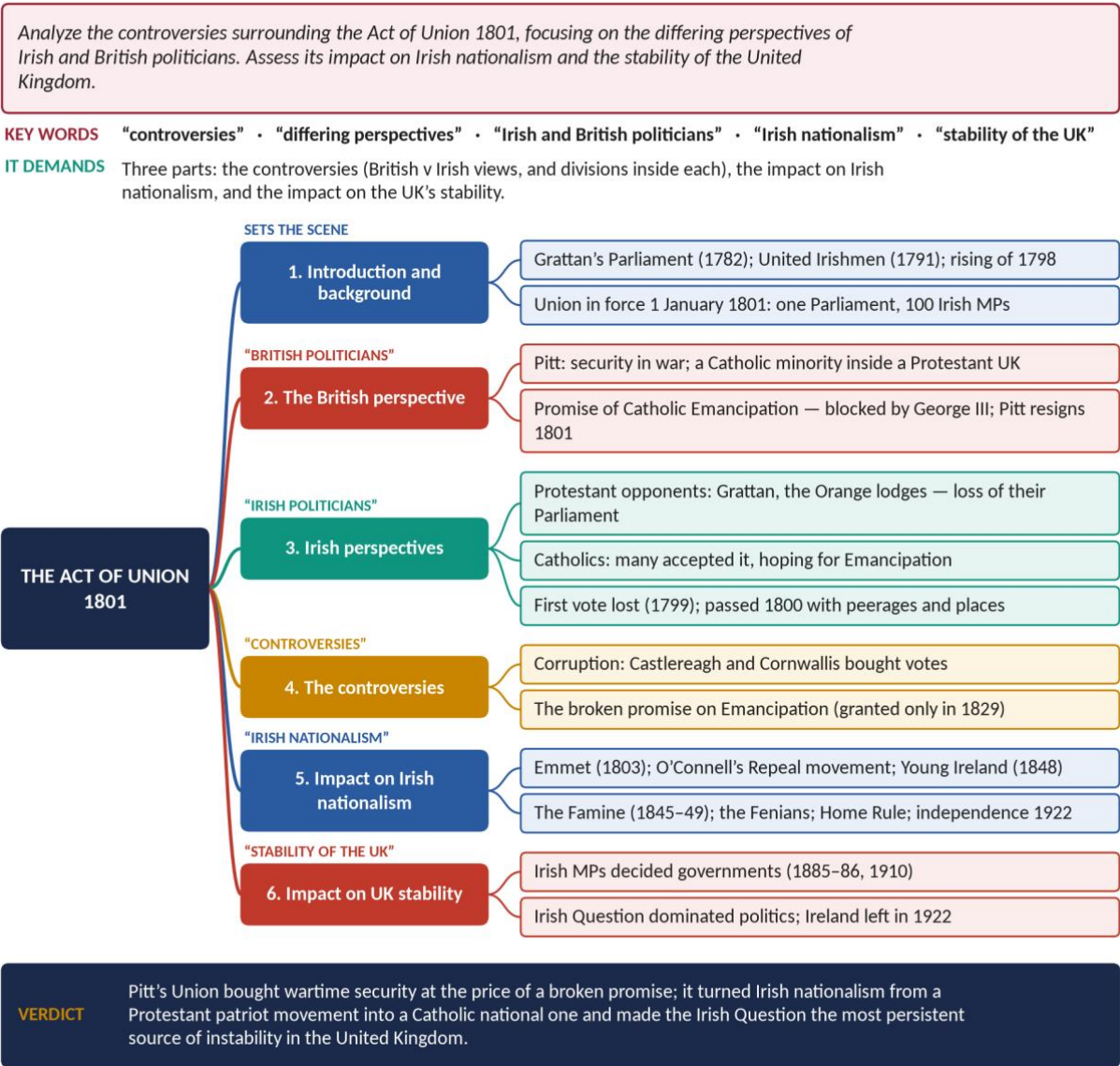


Figure 7 · The answer map for CSS 2025 · Q3 · Section A: every branch is one heading of the answer below.

DECODING THE QUESTION

Three tasks: (1) the **controversies**, organised around the **differing perspectives of Irish and British politicians** — and remember that Irish politicians were themselves divided (Protestant and Catholic); (2) the **impact on Irish nationalism**; (3) the **impact on the stability of the United Kingdom**.

The model answer

(1) Introduction and thesis

The **Act of Union**, in force from **1 January 1801**, abolished the Irish Parliament and created the **United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland**. It was **Pitt's** answer to the **1798** rising and to the danger of a French "back door" in wartime. It was controversial from the start — bought with patronage, opposed by Protestant patriots, accepted by Catholics on a promise that was broken — and its long-term effect was to turn Irish nationalism into a Catholic national movement and to make the **Irish Question** the most persistent source of instability in British politics.

(2) Background

- The **Protestant Ascendancy** governed a Catholic majority under the **Penal Laws**.
- **Grattan's Parliament** (1782) won legislative independence but remained Protestant.
- The **United Irishmen** (1791), under **Wolfe Tone**, moved from reform to republicanism; the **1798** rising, helped by a French landing at Killala, cost about **30,000** lives.

IRELAND: THE RISING OF 1798 AND THE UNION OF 1801

A rebellion with French help, crushed in weeks; Pitt's answer was to abolish the Irish Parliament

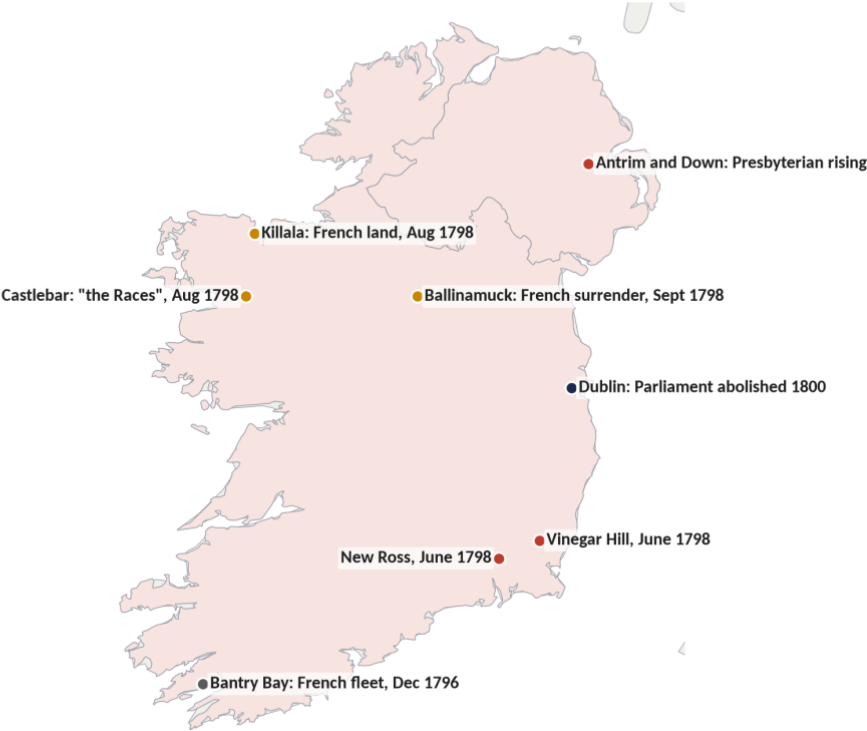


Figure 8 · 1798: the rising and the French landing that convinced Pitt to abolish the Irish Parliament.

(3) The British perspective

- **Security:** Ireland was a gateway for French invasion; a single Parliament would control it.
- **Control:** an independent Dublin Parliament could defy London (as over the Regency in 1788–89).
- **Religion:** inside a Protestant United Kingdom, Catholics would be a minority and could safely be **emancipated**.
- **Economy:** free trade would bring prosperity to Ireland.

(4) The Irish perspectives

Group	Perspective
Protestant patriots (Grattan, Foster)	Union destroyed "their" Parliament and Ireland's nationhood; they fought it bitterly
The Orange Order	Divided: many feared Union would bring Catholic Emancipation
Catholic leaders and bishops	Many supported or accepted it, expecting Emancipation from a Westminster Parliament
The borough-owners	Could be bought — and were

(5) The controversies

1. **Corruption:** the Irish Commons **rejected** Union in 1799; in 1800 it passed after **Castlereagh** and **Cornwallis** distributed peerages, places and about **£1.25 million** in compensation to the owners of abolished boroughs.
2. **The broken promise:** Pitt had implied that **Catholic Emancipation** would follow. **George III** refused, citing his coronation oath; Pitt **resigned** (February 1801). Emancipation came only in **1829**, extracted by **O'Connell's** mass movement.
3. **Representation:** Ireland, with about a third of the UK's population, received only **100** of 658 seats.

(6) The impact on Irish nationalism

- **From Protestant to Catholic nationalism:** the patriot tradition of Grattan gave way to a Catholic movement — **O'Connell's** Catholic Association and **Repeal** campaign (1840s).
- **Revolutionary republicanism:** **Emmet** (1803), **Young Ireland** (1848), the **Fenians** (from 1858), the Easter Rising (1916).
- **The Famine** (1845–49) under the Union — about a million dead and a million emigrants — became the central grievance.
- **Constitutional nationalism:** **Home Rule** (Butt, **Parnell**, Redmond) from the 1870s.

(7) The impact on the stability of the United Kingdom

- The Irish Question **split Peel's party** (Corn Laws in the Famine, 1846) and **Gladstone's** (Home Rule, 1886).
- Irish MPs held the **balance of power** in 1885–86 and 1910, forcing Home Rule onto the agenda.
- **Ulster Unionism** and the crisis of 1912–14 brought Britain close to civil war.
- The Union ended for most of Ireland in **1922** (Irish Free State); Northern Ireland's troubles (1968–98) were its last legacy.

(8) Conclusion

The Act of Union was a **wartime security measure** carried by corruption and sold to Catholics on a promise the King would not keep. British politicians saw it as the solution to the Irish problem; Protestant patriots saw it as the death of their nation; Catholics saw it as a bargain that was broken. By turning Irish nationalism into a Catholic, national and eventually republican movement, the Union created the **Irish Question** that destabilised British politics for more than a century and ended, for most of Ireland, in independence in 1922.

WHY THIS ANSWER SCORES

The two named perspectives are set out separately — and the Irish side is shown to be divided, which most candidates miss. Nationalism and stability each get their own section, carried forward to 1922 so the "impact" is complete.

Part Two — The Past MCQs, Solved

CSS 2024 · MCQ 15

The Battle of Waterloo was fought on:

(A) 18 June 1815	(B) 18 June 1915	(C) 18 June 1917	(D) None of these
------------------	------------------	------------------	-------------------

REMEMBER · Answer: A. 18 June 1815

Waterloo was fought on **18 June 1815**; Wellington and Blücher defeated Napoleon's final campaign, the Hundred Days.

CSS 2026 · MCQ 5

The Act of Union 1801 created the United Kingdom of:

(A) Great Britain and Scotland	(B) England and Scotland	(C) Great Britain and Ireland	(D) None of these
--------------------------------	--------------------------	-------------------------------	-------------------

REMEMBER · Answer: C. Great Britain and Ireland

The Act of Union 1801 joined **Great Britain** (England, Wales and Scotland, united in 1707) with **Ireland**, creating the United Kingdom of Great Britain and Ireland.

CSS 2026 · MCQ 15

The French Revolution led to Britain:

(A) Supporting the French monarchy	(B) Declaring war on France	(C) Remaining neutral	(D) None of these
------------------------------------	-----------------------------	-----------------------	-------------------

REMEMBER · Answer: D. None of these — revolutionary France declared war on Great Britain on 1 February 1793

Britain did not declare war, support the French monarchy, or stay neutral: **revolutionary France declared war on Britain on 1 February 1793**. None of the options fits, so the key is "None of these".

Part Three — Five Predicted Questions, with Outlines

NOTE · Why these five

They come from the topic's blind spots: the **Napoleonic Wars** themselves, **Pitt the Younger**, **Burke and Paine** as a question on their own, and the **Irish rising**.

Predicted 1 · "How did Britain contribute to the defeat of Napoleon?"

- **Thesis:** sea power made Britain invulnerable and money kept the coalitions alive; the Peninsula and Waterloo were Britain's direct contribution on land.
- **Headings:** (1) Why Britain fought · (2) Sea power: the Nile, Trafalgar, blockade · (3) Money: income tax, credit, subsidies to seven coalitions · (4) Economic war: Continental System v Orders in Council · (5) The Peninsular War · (6) Waterloo and Vienna · (7) Verdict: decisive, but alongside Russia, Austria and Prussia.

Predicted 2 · "Assess the impact of the Napoleonic Wars on Britain."

- **Headings:** (1) Finance: £1,000 million, income tax, debt · (2) Economy: industry, agriculture, the Corn Law (1815) · (3) Society: repression, identity, post-war distress · (4) Politics: Tory dominance; Peterloo and the Six Acts · (5) World role: Vienna, bases, naval supremacy · (6) Verdict.

Predicted 3 · "Evaluate Pitt the Younger as a peacetime reformer and a war minister."

- **Thesis:** a first-rate reformer of finance before 1793, a determined but uninspired war leader after it.
- **Headings:** (1) Rise to power (1783–84) · (2) Finance and trade · (3) India, Canada, the slave trade · (4) The failure of reform · (5) War strategy · (6) Repression · (7) The Union and resignation · (8) Verdict.

Predicted 4 · "Compare the political ideas of Edmund Burke and Thomas Paine."

- **Headings:** (1) Context: Price's sermon and the debate · (2) Society and tradition v natural rights · (3) 1688 v 1789 · (4) Monarchy and aristocracy · (5) Change: gradual reform v revolution · (6) Influence: conservatism and radicalism · (7) Verdict.

Predicted 5 · "What were the causes and consequences of the Irish rebellion of 1798?"

- **Headings:** (1) The Protestant Ascendancy and the Penal Laws · (2) Grattan's Parliament · (3) The United Irishmen and France · (4) The rising and the French landing · (5) Consequences: repression, the Union, the Emancipation question · (6) Verdict.